called as the deposition. When a river moves in a gentle slope, its speed reduces and river begins to deposit its load. The river starts depositing larger materials first and smaller and finer materials are carried further down to the mouth of the river.

4.6.1 Stages of the River

The course of a river includes the upper stage, the middle stage, and the final stage. Each stage of the river is dominated by a kind of work. Let's discuss the stages of a river, the main work and the landforms made in each stage.

1. The Upper Stage

The upper stage of a river is also called the youthful stage or mountain stage. The velocity and speed of the stream are very high because the slope here is steep. The vertical erosion is the most dominant work here. The valley is formed here. The place where a river starts is called a **source**. In the mountain stage, the number of small streams originates from different locations. They are called **Tributaries**. The place where two rivers join is called as **the confluence**. The mountain which has two river systems draining on either side of the slope is termed as **the water divide**.

2. The Middle Stage

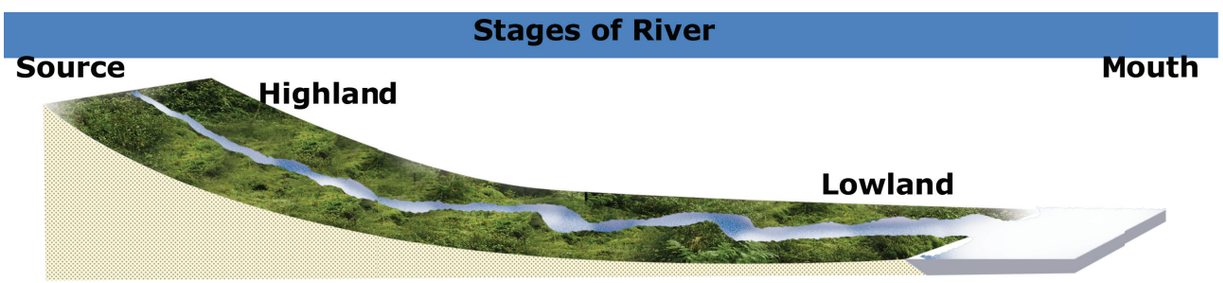
Middle stage is the matured stage of a river. Vertical erosion or deepening of the valley is significantly reduced. Lateral erosion is the dominant work. Due to the lateral erosion of this stage, the widening of the valley occurs. The volume of the river water increases and the slope of river is moderate. The depth of the river is deep here.

3. The Lower Stage

This is the final stage of a river where the valleys are extremely broad and it has generally gentle slope. The valley becomes almost flat which is called a peneplain. Most of the peneplain forms low residual

Students activity

Look at the diagram, read the table of content carefully and fill in the columns with suitable words.



	Upper Stage	Middle Stage	Lower Stage
Erosion			
Gradient			
Depth			
Velocity			
Width			
Volume			

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